



Standard issue

Both armies used versions of this .58-caliber rifle-musket. In the north it was known as the Springfield, after the Massachusetts armory in which it was made.

Victories and defeats

Superior Confederate leadership led to early success, notably with Stonewall Jackson's victory at Bull Run, Virginia in July 1861, reprised in August 1862, when Union forces failed to push the Confederates away from Washington. The turning point was Confederate

general Robert E. Lee's attempt to invade the Union, and his defeat at Gettysburg, Pennsylvania in a three-day battle in July 1863.

In the west, Union general Ulysses S. Grant (see left) held Shiloh, Tennessee in April 1862, and then took Vicksburg on the Mississippi in July 1863, cutting Arkansas, Louisiana, and Texas off from the rest of the Confederacy. In the fall of 1864, Union general William Sherman began to advance through Georgia to the sea, before moving north through the Carolinas. In Virginia, Grant's victories against Lee reduced the

Confederate army to barely 60,000 troops. The fall of the Confederate capital on April 3, 1865 led to Lee's surrender to Grant at Appomattox Court House on April 9. The Union had won.

The reckoning

This was the first modern technological war. Railroads transported men and supplies to the front, messages were telegraphed, iron-clad warships fought for the first time, and photographers and journalists brought the war to people every day via newspapers. The human toll was immense: 360,000 Union dead and 275,000 wounded, 258,000 Confederate dead and 100,000 wounded. Economically, the south was ruined.

The main outcome of the war was emancipation. Lincoln had initially fought to preserve the Union, not free the slaves, but abolitionists in the north, and the effect of escaped slaves fighting in the Union army, changed his mind. On January 1, 1863 Lincoln's Emancipation Proclamation had freed the slaves in the Confederacy, though he did not have the constitutional authority to abolish slavery, nor the power in the south to do so.

Lincoln himself did not live to see the effects of this action: he was shot at a theater in Washington on April 14, 1865, and died the next day.

Although the end of the war led to the reunification of the country, it took years for the new laws to be accepted.

EMANCIPATION

The Emancipation Proclamation of 1863 became the 13th amendment to the Constitution in 1865. The 14th amendment, passed in 1868, gave the **former slaves US citizenship** (American Indians had to wait until 1924), and the 15th amendment of 1870 guaranteed their **right to vote**. In many cases, however, these were paper rights, as racial discrimination lasted for the next century.



EMANCIPATION PROCLAMATION

RECONSTRUCTION

After the war, the south was occupied by federal troops. From 1866–77 Congress attempted **"Reconstruction" in the South**. Former Confederate officials were prohibited from holding public office, veterans were required to pledge allegiance to the Union, and newly freed slaves ran in state elections. Confederate states were readmitted to the Union only after they had accepted the 14th amendment. However, the founding of the white supremacist Ku Klux Klan in Tennessee in 1865 showed the reluctance of some Southerners to accept emancipation.

84th Regiment

This flag belonged to the 84th Regiment, United States Colored Troops, and is inscribed with some of the battles in which they participated, alongside a larger force of Union army volunteers.



Confederate flag, Snodgrass Hill

The 2nd Battalion Hilliard's Alabama Legion attacked Snodgrass Hill during the Battle of Chickamauga, Georgia, September 1863. Their flag was pierced 83 times by Union troops.

